

# Elena Vasquez

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## Senior Backend Engineer

Backend engineer with 9 years building distributed payment and event systems. Led the migration of a monolithic billing service to event-driven microservices handling 40,000 events per second.

## Experience

### Staff Backend Engineer, Stripe-adjacent fintech (Ravelin Pay) — 2021 to 2026

- Designed an idempotent payments ledger in Python and PostgreSQL processing \$2.3B annually.
- Migrated 18 services from RabbitMQ to Apache Kafka, cutting p99 latency from 780ms to 120ms.
- Introduced Kubernetes-based autoscaling on AWS EKS, reducing compute spend 34%.
- Mentored 5 engineers; ran the backend hiring loop and system design interviews.

### Senior Software Engineer, Datadog — 2018 to 2021

- Built a Go ingestion pipeline for 1.2M metrics per second with Redis-backed dedupe.
- Owned on-call for the metrics tier; drove SLO from 99.5% to 99.95% availability.

### Software Engineer, Rackspace — 2017 to 2018

- Wrote Python automation for OpenStack provisioning; reduced setup from 3 days to 4 hours.

## Skills

Python, Go, PostgreSQL, Apache Kafka, Redis, Kubernetes, Docker, AWS, Terraform, gRPC, GraphQL, pytest, distributed systems, event sourcing, observability

## Education

B.S. Computer Science, University of California Berkeley, 2017